



OF THE 39 CROREPATIS THAT EMERGED FROM THE AUCTION, A WHOPPING 21 ARE PACE BOWLERS

Regal comeback: Mitchell Starc will return to the IPL in 2024 for the first time since 2015 after opting not to enter the auction for the past five years. GETTYIMAGES

auctions refreshing, although the concept itself may have reached its sell-by date.

Recency bias plays a part. It was reflected in the Australian trio of Travis Head, Pat Cummins, and Starc returning to the IPL with a bang.

Similarly, Daryl Mitchell and his Kiwi junior Rachin Ravindra also hit the headlines, one for getting his worth and the other as a possible steal.

Pace is pace, yaar

If overseas allrounders were the flavour of the 2023 auction, the fast bowlers raked in the moolah this time.

Of the 39 crorepatis who emerged from the auction, a whopping 21 were pace bowlers. Ten of them fetched equal to or more than Rs. 5 crore.

No doubt the Knight Riders had to refill virtually their entire pace bowling unit, but even the other teams had to change their strategies at the last minute. It is understood that during the pre-auction briefing on the eve of the event in Dubai, an IPL executive told the gathering about the amendment of two bouncers being allowed per over.

It made the teams go big on fast bowlers. It will be interesting to see if the pacers succeed in bouncing out the opposition batters come March 22.

Domestic talent gets its due

They had been excluded from the auction for the first few editions. But ever since uncapped domestic cricketers were inducted into the auction fold in 2014, some of the little-known domestic cricketers have been earning big bucks.

Over the last couple of years, the IPL authorities have gone a step further and started introducing domestic cricketers up front in the auction. It's resulted in more crorepatis among the domestic pack.

The trend continued this time around as eight uncapped domestic cricketers were signed for an eight-figure sum. Chennai Super Kings outbid others to have Sameer Rizvi, a hard-hitting Uttar Pradesh batter, on its roster for a stunning Rs. 8.40 crore, while Delhi Capitals went all the way to have Jharkhand wicketkeeper-batter Kumar Kushagra on board for Rs. 7.40 crore. "All the domestic players are looking forward to the IPL. Delhi was the first to back the youngsters. We talk about Shreyas Iyer, Rishabh Pant, and Prithvi (Shaw); we are the